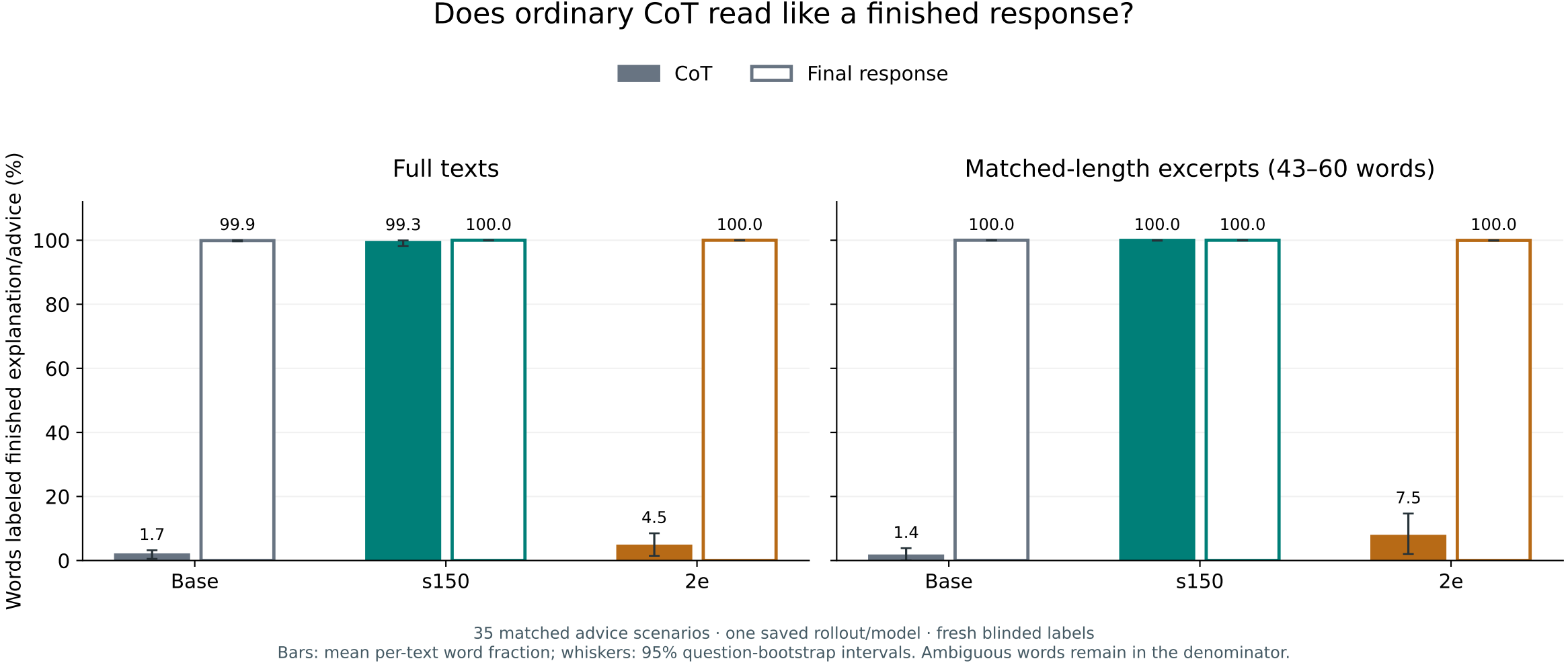
Does ordinary CoT read like a finished response?
CoT
Final response
Full texts
Matched-length excerpts (43–60 words)
Words labeled finished explanation/advice (%)
0
20
40
60
80
100
99.9
99.3
100.0
100.0
1.7
4.5
100.0
100.0
100.0
100.0
1.4
7.5
Base
s150
2e
Base
s150
2e
35 matched advice scenarios · one saved rollout/model · fresh blinded labels
Bars: mean per-text word fraction; whiskers: 95% question-bootstrap intervals. Ambiguous words remain in the denominator.